

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE
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<u>Section</u>	<u>Page</u>
1. Purpose	1
2. Special Instructions/Cancellations	1
3. Scope	2
4. Background	2
5. Procedures	2
6. Inquiries	15
Appendix A – Acronyms and Abbreviations	A-1
Appendix B – Definitions	B-1
Appendix C – Authorities and References	C-1

1. PURPOSE

- a. This Departmental Guidebook (DG) provides procedural guidance to support Departmental Regulation [\(DR\) 4600-004](#), *Foreign Visits and Assignments Vetting*.
- b. This DG provides user instructions for the Foreign National Vetting (FNV) application (App), a centralized case management tool for the risk assessment process applied to non-United States (U.S.) citizens, in accordance with DR 4600-004.

2. SPECIAL INSTRUCTIONS/CANCELLATIONS

- a. This DG is effective immediately when published.
- b. Mission Areas, agencies, and staff offices must align their policies and procedures with this DG within calendar 180 days of the publish date.

3. SCOPE

- a. This DG applies to all facilities owned or operated (e.g., owned, leased, or occupied) by the United States Department of Agriculture (USDA) in the U.S., and to all Federal employees or any person not federally employed who visits or performs duties in partnership with or on behalf of USDA, such as a consultant, contractor, advisor, volunteer, student, or intern.
- b. This DG also applies to designated Foreign Visits and Assignments (FVA) point-of-contact (POC) who will be responsible for submitting FNV requests.

4. BACKGROUND

- a. The Secretary of Agriculture has delegated authority to the Director of the Office of Homeland Security (OHS) for matters relating to counterintelligence (CI) and insider threats ([7 Code of Federal Regulations \(CFR\) § 2.95](#), *Director, Office of Homeland Security*). Within OHS, the FNV process seeks to detect, deter, and protect against espionage, insider threats, and external adversaries in accordance with [DR 4600-003](#), *USDA Defensive Counterintelligence and Insider Threat Programs*.
- b. The FNV process is specifically conducted to assess risks from a national security, CI, and anti-terrorism perspective, prior to granting a non-U.S. Citizen access to the Department's facilities, personnel, programs, information, or systems within the U.S. in accordance with criteria outlined in DR 4600-004. It includes queries against multiple intelligence community and law enforcement databases. It can support, but does not replace, investigative action conducted for credentialing, fitness, and suitability determinations.

5. PROCEDURES

- a. Designating Agency Contacts
 - (1) DR 4600-004 requires each Mission Area, agency, and staff office to identify at least one primary and alternate FVA POC who will be responsible for submitting FNV requests, also known as tickets, to OHS via the FNV App. FVA POCs may be Federal employees or contractors who have been deemed suitable to hold a minimum of a Public Trust position.
 - (2) FVA POCs handling credentialing, fitness, and suitability determinations are uniquely positioned to identify non-U.S. Citizens who will onboard at USDA in a Federal or non-Federal (e.g., contractor, consultants, visiting scientist) position. Offices who manage volunteer programs that include foreign nationals or foreign exchange programs at USDA are also positioned to submit FNV tickets in advance of projected arrival dates.

- (3) Each user requires a seat license to use the FNV App. Licenses are renewed annually each May and are allocated as requested by Mission Areas, agencies, and staff offices. OHS will validate the need for user licenses to the FNV App on an annual basis prior to the renewal period.
 - (4) The FVA POCs directory may be requested by emailing FVALiaison@usda.gov. Any changes to the FVA POC directory must be emailed to FVALiaison@usda.gov.
 - (5) OHS will provide training to all FVA POCs on FNV policy, vetting requirements, FNV App demonstration, and their roles and responsibilities. Access to the FNV App is not provided by OHS until the FVA POC has completed training.
- b. Accessing the FNV App
- (1) Designated FVA POCs are granted access to the FNV App by OHS. Following the completion of training, they will receive an email from OHS with the link to access the FNV App. Access to the FNV App is through eAuthentication using a personal identity verification (PIV) card, also known as a LincPass.
 - (2) FVA POCs will only have access to the to the Mission Area, agency, or staff office records they service. Only the OHS Director, or their designee, and technical support will have access to all records in the FNV App.
- c. Creating a Ticket on a New Non-U.S. Citizen
- (1) FVA POCs will access the FNV App to submit a FNV ticket to OHS. Most of the required information on the non-U.S. Citizen is obtained from various forms completed for the background investigation process, such as:
 - (a) [Standard Form \(SF\) 85](#), *Questionnaire for Non-Sensitive Positions*;
 - (b) [SF 85P](#), *Questionnaire For Public Trust Positions*;
 - (c) [Optional Form \(OF\) 306](#), *Declaration for Federal Employment*;
 - (d) Exchange visitor forms; and
 - (e) Other research collaboration documents.
 - (2) The user performs the following steps:
 - (a) Login to the FNV App.

- (b) On the home screen, leave the **Search for Existing Foreign National** field empty and click the **New** button to proceed.
 - (c) On the **Enter Foreign National (FN) Info (Step 1 of 4)** screen, complete the required fields **Personnel Type**, **Agency Name**, and **Purpose of Visit**.
 - (d) **Personnel Type** drop-down selections:
 - 1 “Advisory Committee” includes board members;
 - 2 “Federal Employee” includes Applicants;
 - 3 “IT Contractor” includes any contractor who is performing information technology (IT) related duties;
 - 4 “Non-IT Contractor” includes any contractor who is not performing IT related duties;
 - 5 “R&D or S&T Assignment” includes all formal arrangements to conduct Research and Development (R&D) or Science and Technology (S&T) related activities;
 - 6 “R&D or S&T Visitor” includes any visit involving R&D or S&T related discussions or activities; or
 - 7 “Visitor” includes any visit that is not associated with R&D or S&T related discussions or activities.
 - (e) For **Agency Name**, select the appropriate [Mission Area](#), [Agency](#), or [Staff Office](#) the individual will be visiting or working with.
 - (f) The **Purpose of Visit** field becomes fillable and required for **Personnel Types** “Visitor,” “R&D or S&T Assignment,” and “R&D or S&T Visitor.” Although someone on assignment is not a true visitor, it is included in this field to obtain a brief statement of the work they will be conducting per their arrangement. For R&D or S&T discussions or activities, please indicate the subject matter or related initiative that will be involved in the assignment or visit.
- (3) When all required fields and any supplemental information has been completed, click on the **Next** button at the bottom of the screen.
- (4) If the FNV App identifies that duplicate information belonging to an existing record has been entered for the **Permanent Resident Card Number**, **Foreign Passport Number**, and **Visa Number** fields, a warning message will be displayed upon clicking the **Next** button. To proceed with creating the duplicate non-U.S. Citizen

record, click the **Next** button. To create a new non-U.S. Citizen record, click the **Previous** button.

- (5) If the **Next** button is clicked before completing all of the required fields (marked with a red asterisk), a validation message will display, and the cursor will appear in the field missing data. The user will be able to click the **Next** button when the validation errors have been corrected.
 - (6) See Section 5e, *Entering Ticket Details*, for more instructions.
- d. Creating a Ticket for a Non-U.S. Citizen with an Existing FNV App Record
- (1) On the tab labeled **Home**, in the **Search for Existing Foreign National** field, enter the name of the non-U.S. Citizen. Matching contact records will be displayed below the field. If an existing record is not located, create a new ticket.
 - (2) If the top option of **Show All Results for** (name of the existing non-U.S. Citizen) is clicked, the user will be shown additional information on each search result. The results can be searched and filtered for any field shown.
 - (3) Once the existing non-U.S. Citizen's name is displayed, click on the name to populate it in the **Search for Existing Foreign National** field.
 - (4) Click the **New** button to generate the ticket.
 - (5) On the **Enter Foreign National (FN) Info (Step 1 of 4)** screen, complete the required fields **Personnel Type**, **Agency Name**, and **Purpose of Visit**.
 - (a) **Personnel Type** drop-down selections:
 - 1 "Advisory Committee" includes board members;
 - 2 "Federal Employee" includes Applicants;
 - 3 "IT Contractor" includes any contractor who is IT related duties;
 - 4 "Non-IT Contractor" includes any contractor who is not performing IT related duties;
 - 5 "R&D or S&T Assignment" includes all formal arrangements to conduct R&D or S&T related activities;
 - 6 "R&D or S&T Visitor" includes any visit involving R&D or S&T related discussions or activities; or

- 7 “Visitor” includes any visit that is not associated with R&D or S&T related discussions or activities.
- (b) For **Agency Name**, select the appropriate Mission Area, agency, or staff office the individual will be visiting or working with.
- (c) The **Purpose of Visit** field becomes fillable and required for **Personnel Types** “R&D or S&T Assignment,” “R&D or S&T Visitor,” and “Visitor.” Although someone on assignment is not a true visitor, it is included in this field to obtain a brief statement of the work they will be conducting per their arrangement. For R&D or S&T discussions or activities, please indicate the subject matter or related initiative that will be involved in the assignment or visit.
- (6) Verify that any information auto-populated on the **Enter Foreign National (FN) Info (Step 1 of 4)** screen is still correct. When the information has been verified and all required fields completed, click on the **Next** button.
- (7) If the FVA POC enters any information in the **Permanent Resident Card Number** or **Foreign Passport Number** fields, additional required fields will appear for the expiration dates.
- (8) If the **Next** button is clicked before completing all of the required fields (marked with a red asterisk), a validation message will display, and the cursor will appear in the field missing data. The user will be able to click the **Next** button when the validation errors have been corrected.
- (9) See Section 5e, *Entering Ticket Details*, for more instructions.

e. Entering Ticket Details

The process for a new non-U.S. Citizen coming to USDA or for a non-U.S. Citizen who already exists in the FNV App is the same.

- (1) Complete all required fields on the **Enter Submitting FVA POC Info (Step 2 of 4)** screen.
- (a) Under **FVA POC**, search for and select the individual’s name.
- (b) The options for **FNV Type** are:
- 1 “Initial,” indicating that this is the first vetting request conducted at USDA for the individual;
- 2 “Reciprocity,” indicating that there is already an existing favorable FNV vetting result on record with USDA, or another Federal agency, within the last 24 months. An expedited FNV ticket must be requested if the prior

foreign vetting result is within 30 calendar days of reaching 24 months;
and

- 3 “CV Check,” (Continuous Vetting), used by OHS to track follow-up subsequent vetting actions, per Section 5k, *Continuous Vetting on Foreign Nationals*, that follows.

- (2) Click the **Next** button when all fields have been completed. If any required fields are not completed, a validation error message will be displayed. To return to the Step 1 screen to revise the non-U.S. Citizen’s information, click on the **Previous** button.
- (3) Complete all required fields indicated by a red asterisk on the **Enter Visiting/Duty Location (U.S. Location Only) Information (Step 3 of 4)** screen. If the individual is working remotely in the U.S., select “Remote.”
 - (a) The **USDA Facility Name** field references the General Services Administration’s listing of all USDA locations. As a location name may be different than what an employee is accustomed to and may show multiple sites across a location’s campus, it is recommended that the user enter the city and state of the location and select from the list of locations that appears. If a location appears to be missing from the selections, please email FVALiaison@usda.gov to inquire.
 - (b) Enter the **Projected Arrival/Start Date**. For some individuals who arrived prior to the release of DR 4600-004, the projected arrival date may have already occurred. Those requests will be accepted.
 - (c) Enter the **Projected Departure Date**. For Federal employees, this is left blank; for contractors and research assignments, enter the end date of the contract or arrangement.
 - (d) The **Actual Arrival Date** and **Actual Departure Date** will be updated when known. For some individuals who arrived prior to the release of DR 4600-004, the actual arrival date may have already occurred. FVA POCs or hosts can provide this information to FVALiaison@usda.gov. OHS will utilize the web-based Security Entry Tracking System to obtain this information on Federal employees, contractors, and those here on assignment.
- (4) Click the **Next** button when all fields have been completed. If any required fields are incomplete, a validation error message will be displayed.
- (5) On the **Enter Host/Supervisor (Step 4 of 4)** screen, select a Mission Area, agency, or staff office from the **Agency** picklist. If the individual is on a “Research Assignment” or any type of visitor, enter the name of the host. If the individual is

any type of contractor, enter the name of the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR). If the individual is a Federal employee, enter the supervisor's information.

- (6) If the host, COR, or supervisor is an existing contact in the Outlook global address list, search for and select the name, which will auto-populate. If the name is not listed as an existing contact, enter information in the **Host First Name**, **Host Last Name**, and **Host Email** fields to create a new contact.
 - (7) Click the **Save** button when all fields have been completed. If any required fields are incomplete, a validation error message will be displayed.
 - (8) A **Success!** window will be displayed confirming that the ticket has been entered into the FNV App successfully. Click the **Here** hyperlink to review the ticket that was just created to conduct a quality review of the information entered.
- f. Submitting Ticket and Attachments to OHS
- (1) To submit the ticket, click the **Submit to OHS** button in the top right of the page.
 - (2) A window will be displayed for the user to **Add Attachments**, such as a resume and passport photo. Attachments are not required, but resumes are preferred for individuals filling R&D or S&T assignments or positions. The additional documentation assists in the vetting process. If documentation is not provided but deemed necessary by the Insider Threat or CI Programs, it will be requested.
 - (3) To attach any documentation, click on the **Upload Files** button in the pop up, then select the file to attach. When the file has been uploaded, click the **Done** button.
 - (4) Another way to create an attachment is to drag and drop the file inside the **Or Drop Files** box on the window. Multiple files may be attached this way, and although they are not displayed in the window, they are visible in the **Notes & Attachments** section of the ticket.
 - (5) When attachments have been successfully added to the ticket, or should the user prefer to provide no attachments, click the **Save and Next** button.
 - (6) A window will appear to **Expedite Vetting Ticket**. If you would like to expedite the ticket, select the **Expedite FNV?** toggle. Another window will appear. Provide a brief justification for the expedite request. Select **Submit**.
 - (7) If everything is submitted correctly, you will see **Success!** Select **Finish** to close the window.
 - (8) After being submitted to OHS, the ticket moves to "**Submitted to OHS**" on the status progress bar. The user can view the ticket as it moves through the vetting

process, if needed, and will receive an email when the vetting process has been completed.

g. Cancelling a Ticket

If an individual cancels their planned visit or assignment, or a Federal employee withdraws their acceptance of a job offer or otherwise becomes inactive while the FNV process is underway, the FVA POC should cancel the active ticket in the FNV App. At a minimum, the FVA POC or host should email FVALiaison@usda.gov about the cancellation of the pending arrival.

- (1) Select **My Submitted Tickets** on the home screen, which will display the most recently submitted tickets. If a ticket is not displayed, click on the **More** button to open the full list of submitted tickets.
- (2) Click on the ticket number for the individual being cancelled.
- (3) Select the **Mark FNV as Cancelled** button in the upper right of the screen.
- (4) In the **Mark FNV as Cancelled** window, enter comments in the **FNV Cancellation Reason** text box, then click the **Save** button.
- (5) To return to the ticket without marking it as cancelled, click the **X** button.

h. Requests for Additional Information

If OHS requires additional information on a ticket to support the FNV process, the **Chatter** feature in the FNV App will be utilized. This creates a tracking log of the requests associated with the ticket. When a message is entered by OHS or an FVA POC, an email notification alert will be sent.

- (1) Click the **Request Additional Information** button in the upper right of the screen.
- (2) In the window that appears, complete the **Comment to FVA POC** field, then click the **Send** button. To exit the window without requesting additional information, click the **X** button.
- (3) The comments will be captured in the **Chatter** component on the right side of the page.
- (4) The FVA POC contact will be tagged in the comment and receive an email notification that a request for additional information has been made.
- (5) The ticket will move to **Additional Info Requested** on the status progress bar, and the **Additional Info Requested** field will be populated with the current date.

i. Recording OHS Vetting Actions

During the FNV process, information may be searched by the CI Program or Insider Threat Program within OHS to identify any risks with the individual or associated business entity, such as foreign intelligence concerns or ties to foreign government-sponsored talent recruitment programs (FTRP)

- (1) Click the **Set Vetting Data** button in the upper right of the screen. The **Set Vetting Data** window will appear for the OHS user to indicate when various actions in the vetting process have been completed.
- (2) Click on one or more of the switch icons to indicate that the corresponding action has been completed. When a field indicates completion, additional required field(s) for that action will display that must be completed before saving the record.
- (3) When an action has been marked complete and the associated field updated, click the **Save** button.
- (4) If a required field(s) is not complete, a validation error message will be displayed.
- (5) After successfully saving the vetting data, the **FNV Vetting Status** progress bar will update based on the completed actions.
- (6) All additional fields entered on the **Set Vetting Data** window will be captured in the **OHS Actions** section of the ticket record.

j. FNV Requests to the Federal Service Provider

- (1) FNV ticket information received by OHS is sent to our Federal service provider to conduct screening services through various intelligence indices checks.
- (2) Screening results from the Federal service provider are returned to OHS in less than 30 calendar days but can be expedited for results in less than 1 week. Any adverse information identified during the assessment process is reviewed by OHS and may extend the response time for the final determination.
- (3) The screening result is entered into the FNV App, which automatically updates the status progress bar and sends an email to the host, COR, or supervisor with the vetting result, and a copy to the designated FVA POC.

k. Continuous Vetting on Foreign Nationals

- (1) CV involves regularly reviewing an individual's background to ensure there are no actionable issues following an initial favorable determination.

- (2) For FNV purposes, OHS will conduct subsequent screening checks on any non-U.S. Citizen who is still active with USDA at a minimum of every 24 months. Additional vetting during the 24 month period can be conducted at any time as deemed necessary to address potential concerns.
- (3) The FNV App will automatically generate an email to the host or supervisor 30 calendar days prior to the due date to confirm active status and request any changes in the individual's information to support the updated screening.

l. Reporting Status Changes

- (1) It is critical for the Department to maintain accurate records on who is accessing our facilities for the safety and security of Departmental personnel and assets. Maintaining up-to-date information on non-U.S. Citizens who are active with the Department supports our reporting, statistics, and ongoing vetting actions. We rely on the agencies to provide updated departure information on non-Federal employees (e.g., contractors, volunteers, research scientists).
- (2) For any non-U.S. Citizen Federal employee or contractor, OHS will periodically check active status in personnel and payroll systems.
- (3) For any non-U.S. Citizen visiting or on assignment at USDA, the host must notify OHS at FVALiaison@usda.gov when:
 - (a) The individual's visit or assignment with USDA has ended;
 - (b) The **Projected Departure Date** has been extended; or
 - (c) The open FNV ticket needs to be cancelled due to the cancellation of a visit or assignment.
- (4) Once an individual has an **Actual Departure Date** entered in the FNV App, future vetting actions will cease.

m. Reciprocity

- (1) OHS will transfer available historical FNV records into the FNV App to support subsequent tickets on the same individual (prepopulating personally identifiable information (PII) for efficiency, see [DR 3515-002](#), *Privacy Policy and Compliance for Personally Identifiable Information (PII)* and [DR 3440-003](#), *Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI) Program*) and reciprocity. Within FNV, reciprocity is the use of a prior, favorable FNV assessment that is less than 24 months old. If the individual is within 30 calendar days of the end of the 24 month period, they may onboard, but a new FNV ticket must be submitted with expedited service requested. The use of reciprocity allows the individual to onboard with no delay.

For example, if a non-U.S. Citizen departs 6 months after their favorable FNV assessment and returns 1 year later, their information would be collected in the FNV App for tracking purposes, but there would be no need to delay onboarding due to a pending assessment by OHS due to the existence of a favorable assessment already on record that is less than 24 months old.

- (2) If the individual stays onboard (Projected Departure Date) with USDA leading up to the 24-month vetting due date, OHS will initiate the follow-up screening and track the action in the FNV App.

n. Interim Alternative Procedures for Research, Education, and Economics (REE)

The Agricultural Research Service (ARS) administers a legacy application used across the REE Mission Area for tracking FNV requests. Until a technical solution to link the application with the FNV App, ARS will enter all vetting requests they receive into the FNV App, to ensure consolidated tracking and accurate reporting and statistics.

o. FNV Exception (Waiver) Request

- (1) The OHS Director may grant an exception, in extraordinary circumstances, if a Mission Area, agency, or staff office is unable to complete the FNV process before a non-U.S. Citizen arrives at a USDA facility in the U.S. The waiver request must be in writing, justify the reason for the immediate need of the non-U.S. citizen's subject matter expertise, and be signed by the Under Secretary or responsible Mission Area, agency, or staff office head. Information must be provided with the request to describe the purpose of the visit or assignment. The request must be submitted to OHS within 48 hours of the individual's expected arrival at USDA.
- (2) OHS will review and provide a response within 5 business days unless an urgent reason and start date is indicated in the request. The CI Program will identify any CI-related risks and recommend mitigation strategies if the exception is approved. The OHS Director will make a risk-based decision and reply to the requesting Mission Area, agency, or staff office.
- (3) If an exception is granted to allow the non-U.S. citizen to onboard without the completed FNV assessment, the Mission Area, agency, or staff office must submit the FNV request to OHS as soon as possible, but no later than 48 hours after arrival. The request must indicate expedited service is needed.

p. Privacy and Safeguarding of Information

There are risks associated with the handling of the PII necessary for FNV record checks. To minimize these risks, the following strategies are in place:

- (1) The FNV App can only be accessed via a PIV card for eAuthentication;

- (2) Access is restricted to individuals whose duties include processing FNV tickets or background investigations for work with, or on behalf of, USDA or who have a related need-to-know;
- (3) Access to the FNV App is limited to records within the FVA POCs own Mission Area, agency, or staff office;
- (4) Automated email notifications have been established within the FNV App to eliminate the need for hosts or supervisors to access the App directly to receive assessment results;
- (5) Administrator access is limited to OHS Director, or their designee, and technical support;
- (6) Any report downloaded from the FNV App is password-protected to prevent unauthorized access;
- (7) FNV App user accounts are individually approved by OHS;
- (8) All employees receive mandatory annual Information Security Awareness training from the Office of the Chief Information Officer (OCIO) per [DR 3545-001](#);
- (9) FVA POCs must have been found suitable, at a minimum, for a Public Trust position;
- (10) All data in the FNV App environment is hosted in a secure Federal Risk and Authorization Management Program (FedRAMP) Cloud Server;
- (11) Specific security roles have been defined and implemented within the FNV App to control access to information;
- (12) A system security certification was obtained for the FNV App in accordance with the Office of Management and Budget (OMB) Circular No. [A-130](#), *Managing Information as a Strategic Resource*; and
- (13) All FNV App data is encrypted.

q. Auditing and Compliance

The FVA POC list will be verified on an annual basis. The App has auditing capabilities that stamps who, when, and what changes are made to a given record, which can also be elevated to track and audit certain fields.

OHS will proactively seek ways to monitor compliance against DR 4600-004. The information obtained will be crosschecked against the FNV App to identify missing FNV checks. Such sources of information may include:

- (1) A monthly report identifying all fitness and suitability background investigation requests submitted from USDA to the Defensive CI and Security Agency (DCSA) on non-U.S. Citizens;
- (2) A report on non-U.S. citizens who have been issued a PIV card. This will not cover non-U.S. citizens who are issued a site or visitor badge; and
- (3) A report on non-U.S. citizens who have been granted IT user access from OCIO.

OHS will alert the designated Mission Area, agency, or staff office FVA POC to submit an expedited FNV request when a non-U.S. citizen onboard has no record of receiving a FNV assessment in accordance with DR 4600-004.

r. Reporting Concerns

- (1) Report potential insider threat concerns on non-U.S. Citizens on assignment or working at USDA to OHS at insider@usda.gov or [*OHS-Insider Threat Program*](#).
- (2) Stay alert and watch for potential targeting or collection activity. Immediately report suspicious activities or anomalies such as:
 - (a) Undue curiosity about, or requests for access to sensitive or proprietary information, when the individual does not have authorized access or a need-to-know;
 - (b) Bringing cameras or recording devices, without approval, into areas storing sensitive, proprietary, or export-controlled material;
 - (c) Any misuse of information systems or unauthorized transfer of USDA information;
 - (d) Unauthorized removal or attempts to remove sensitive, export-controlled, proprietary, or other protected material from the facility;
 - (e) Any attempts to encourage others to violate laws or disobey security policies and procedures;
 - (f) Contact (phone, email, or social media) from a non-U.S. Citizen after their visit or assignment has been completed, requesting USDA information that is not available to the public or part of any cooperative or S&T arrangement;
 - (g) Accessing the facility outside of normal business hours for no logical reason; or

- (h) Any concerns about other individuals the non-U.S. Citizen invites or hosts into USDA facilities, including relatives.
- (3) Contact local law enforcement or the nearest Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) field office immediately with any national security or terrorism concerns. The FBI will coordinate with USDA on reported issues. The appropriate field office can be located by visiting the [*FBI Field Offices*](#) web page.

6. INQUIRIES

Please send all inquiries regarding this DG to FVALiaison@usda.gov.

- END -

APPENDIX A

ACRONYMS AND ABBREVIATIONS

App	Application
ARS	Agricultural Research Service
CFR	Code of Federal Regulations
CI	Counterintelligence
COR	Contracting Officer's Representative
CUI	Controlled Unclassified Information
CV	Continuous Vetting
DCSA	Defensive Counterintelligence and Security Agency
DG	Departmental Guidebook
DHS	Department of Homeland Security
DR	Departmental Regulation
E.O.	Executive Order
FBI	Federal Bureau of Investigation
FedRAMP	Federal Risk and Authorization Management Program
FN	Foreign National
FNV	Foreign National Vetting
FTRP	Foreign Government-Sponsored Talent Recruitment Program
FVA	Foreign Visits and Assignments
J-1	Exchange Visitor Visa
IT	Information Technology
LPR	Lawful Permanent Resident
OCIO	Office of the Chief Information Officer
OF	Optional Form
OHS	Office of Homeland Security
OMB	Office of Management and Budget
OPM	Office of Personnel Management
PII	Personally Identifiable Information
PIV	Personal Identity Verification
POC	Point of Contact
R&D	Research and Development
REE	Research, Education, and Economics
S&T	Science and Technology
SF	Standard Form
U.S.	United States
U.S.C.	United States Code
USDA	United States Department of Agriculture

APPENDIX B

DEFINITIONS

Arrangement. Term used to describe any and all forms of legally binding documents, whether governed by domestic, foreign or international law, and non-legally binding documents, signed by representatives of the USDA. (Source: [DR 1051-003](#), *Citation of Science & Technology (S&T) Agreements in USDA S&T Arrangements*)

Counterintelligence (CI). Information gathered and activities conducted to identify, deceive, exploit, disrupt, or protect against espionage, other intelligence activities, sabotage, or assassinations conducted for or on behalf of foreign powers, organizations, or persons, or their agents, or international terrorist organizations or activities. (Source: Executive Order [\(E.O.\) 12333](#), *United States Intelligence Activities*, as amended)

Designated FVA POC. Individuals who have been assigned the responsibility and accountability to carry out foreign visits and assignments management for their Mission Area, agency, or staff office.

Foreign National (or Non-U.S. Citizen). A person without U.S. citizenship or nationality (may include a stateless person). This term is synonymous with “noncitizen” and with “alien” as defined in Section 101(a)(3) of the *Immigration and Nationality Act* (8 United States Code (U.S.C.) § 1101(a)(3)). (Source: Department of Homeland Security (DHS), U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services, [Glossary](#))

Foreign National Assignment (or Non-U.S. Citizen Assignment). A non-U.S. Citizen working at a USDA facility in the U.S., whether onsite or remotely. If their duty assignment or arrangement requires access to Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI) or protected information, restricted spaces, or the USDA IT architecture, or they are from a State Sponsor of Terrorism, FNV is required prior to their arrival at USDA. This applies to Federal employees and any category of non-Federal person working with USDA, such as an exchange visitor, consultant, contractor, cooperator, affiliate, advisor, fellow, volunteer, student, intern, research collaborator, or visiting scientist. This also includes university affiliated individuals that may have such access during collaborations with USDA.

Foreign National Vetting (FNV). The screening of non-U.S. citizens to identify any risks from a national security, CI, and anti-terrorism perspective prior to granting access to the Department’s facilities, personnel, programs, information, and systems in accordance with criteria outlined in DR 4600-004. The vetting process supports the Department’s mission, protects USDA assets, and safeguards our national security. The vetting process includes queries and analysis of information obtained across multiple intelligence community and law enforcement databases.

Foreign National Visit (or Non-U.S. Citizen Visit). A non-U.S. Citizen who is visiting a USDA facility in the U.S., but not on assignment or arrangement to work with USDA. If a visit with a non-U.S. Citizen will include access to CUI or protected information, restricted spaces, or the

USDA IT architecture, FNV is required. All non-U.S. Citizen visitors must be escorted at all times by a USDA Federal employee, or as deemed appropriate by their facility security plan or local operating procedures.

Host. A USDA Federal employee who is hosting a non-USDA employee or contractor who will access a USDA facility, program, system, or information. Hosts are responsible for ensuring adherence to all related security requirements.

Insider Threat. The threat that an insider will use their authorized access, wittingly or unwittingly, to do harm to the security of the U.S. This threat can include damage to the U.S. through espionage, terrorism, unauthorized disclosure of national security information, or through the loss or degradation of Departmental resources or capabilities. (Adapted from [E.O. 13587](#), *Structural Reforms to Improve the Security Classified Networks and the Responsible Sharing and Safeguarding of Classified Information*).

J-1 Exchange Visitor Visa. A non-immigrant visa issued by the U.S. to research scholars, professors, and exchange visitors participating in programs that promote cultural exchange within the U.S.

Lawful Permanent Resident (LPR). As defined by the DHS, lawful permanent residents (LPR), also known as “green card” holders, are non-U.S. citizens who are lawfully authorized to live permanently within the U.S. LPRs may accept an offer of employment without special restrictions, own property, receive financial assistance at public colleges and universities, and join the Armed Forces. They also may apply to become U.S. citizens if they meet certain eligibility requirements. FNV checks will be conducted on all LPRs regardless of the amount time spent residing in the U.S.

LincPass. USDA branded its PIV card the “LincPass.” The unique spelling of LincPass is in honor of President Abraham Lincoln, founder of the Department of Agriculture. The card links your personal identity to your ability to access Federal buildings and computer systems. The LincPass will be used for access by USDA employees and affiliates.

Screening. A risk analysis that includes making queries against multiple intelligence community and law enforcement databases to identify any potential issues from a national security, CI, and anti-terrorism perspective. This is also commonly referred to as a name trace.

State Sponsors of Terrorism. Countries that the Department of State has designated to be [State Sponsors of Terrorism](#) because of their identified sponsorship of groups and or activities supporting terrorism or terrorist activities.

APPENDIX C

AUTHORITIES AND REFERENCES

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